Speed vs Value vs Store

What drives Gen Z's festive shopping channel choice in Kolkata

MBA Marketing Project | Marketing and Business Analytics
Shreyasi Ganguly | IQ City United World School of Business
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Executive summary

200

respondents surveyed

72%

put value or quality first

6.5%

put speed first

Brand Store

is the most-used festive channel (28.5%)

Answer to the research question

Value wins: 72% of Gen Z shoppers in Kolkata put value or quality first, against only 6.5% who put speed first.

Main recommendation

Lead festive campaigns with offers and product quality, and keep fast delivery as a last-minute add-on, not the main pitch.

Why this matters now

71%

of quick-commerce users want the best price or overall value

65%

prioritise product quality

22%

care most about fast delivery

+85%

growth in quick-commerce order volume in the first week of 2026 festive sales, versus 2025

-6%

expected change in urban festive spending in 2026 (about Rs 1.97 lakh crore), versus 2025

Sources: Business Today (27 Oct 2026); Deccan Herald (Oct 2026); LocalCircles survey via Upstox (2026).

Research problem and questions

The problem

Quick commerce sells speed, yet recent surveys suggest festive buyers weigh value and quality far more. It is unclear whether this holds for Gen Z in Kolkata and nearby towns, and which channel wins their festive spend.

1

Research question 1

Which channel do Gen Z shoppers use most for festive purchases, and does it differ by area?

2

Research question 2

Does speed or value drive their channel choice?

3

Research question 3

Which customer segments exist, and how should a fashion brand target them?

Research design

1

Survey

Google Form shared with Gen Z, ages 18-26

2

Clean

Remove duplicates and impossible answers

3

Analyse

Excel: COUNTIFS, PivotTables, correlation

4

Segment

Group respondents with simple rules

5

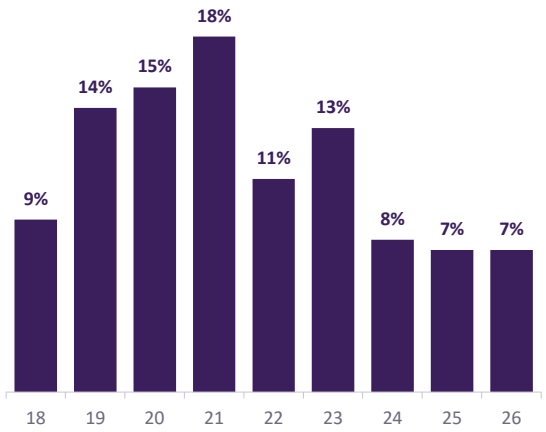
Recommend

Turn findings into brand actions

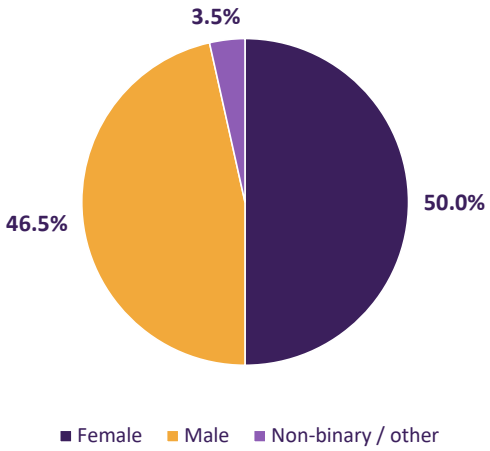
Sample size	Collection period	Coverage	Tools
200 respondents	Oct - Nov 2026	Kolkata core, suburbs, towns	Excel, basic Python

Who responded

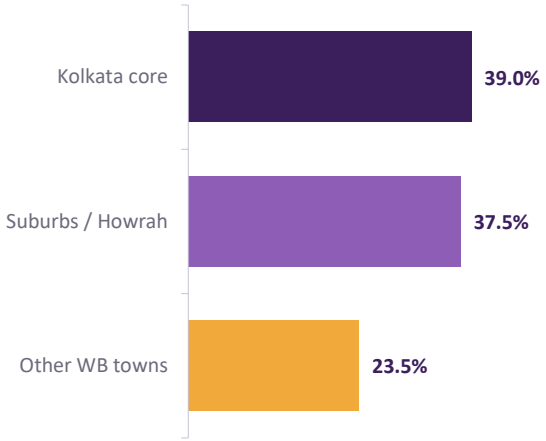
Age



Gender

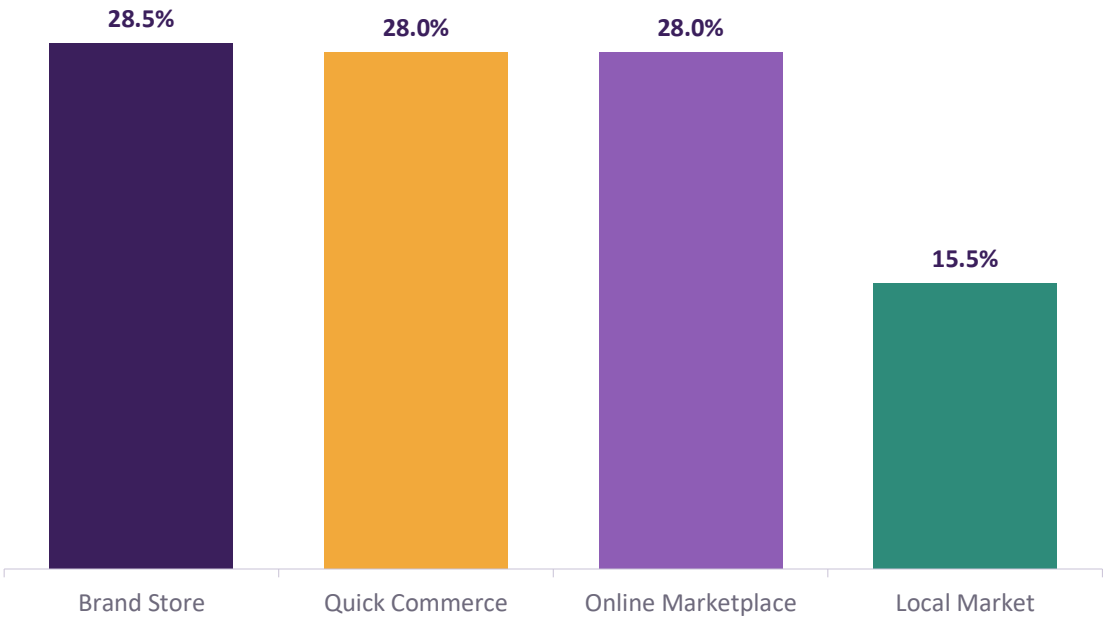


Area



The sample is almost evenly split between women (50%) and men (46.5%) and sits mostly in the 19-23 age band (70%); other West Bengal towns (23.5%) and non-binary respondents (3.5%) are thin, so those cuts are directional, but every group in the research question is covered.

Where Gen Z buys festive items



Leading channel and its share

Brand Store, 28.5%

Highest average festive spend

Quick Commerce, Rs 5,032

Highest satisfaction

Quick Commerce, 4.0 / 5

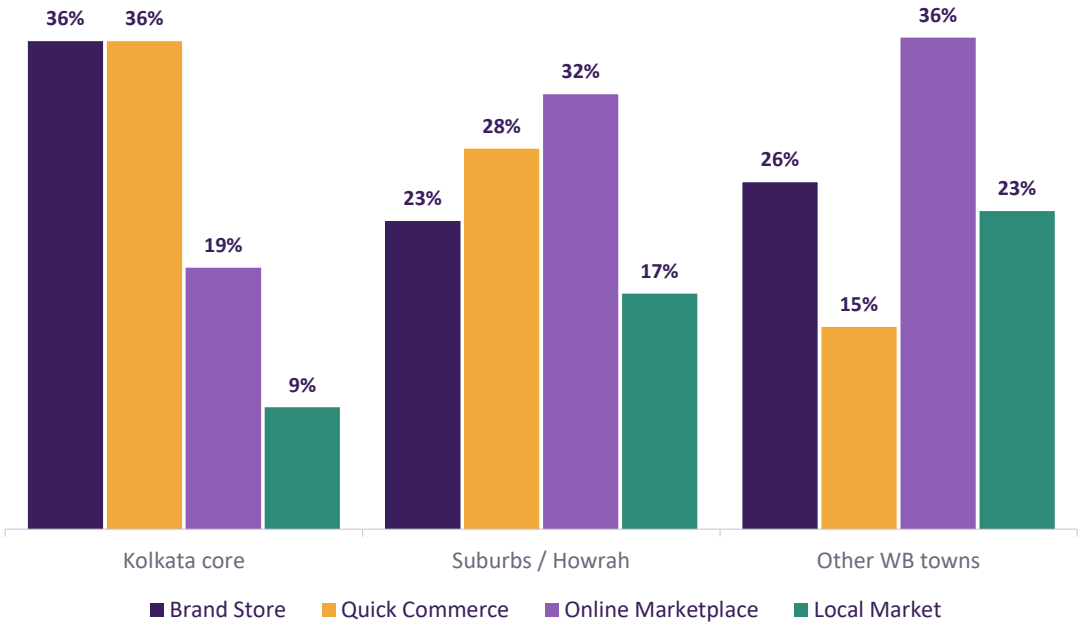
Channel choice differs by area

What to look for

Quick commerce is a core-city habit: 35.9% in Kolkata core, 28.0% in suburbs and 14.9% in other towns.

Local markets still matter outside the core: 23.4% in other towns and 17.3% in suburbs, against 9.0% in the core.

Benchmark: BT-PRICE (Jan 2026) put Mumbai Gen Z far ahead on quick commerce. Kolkata core is strong but not dominant, level with brand stores at 35.9%. Area differences are significant (chi-square p = 0.02).



The speed vs value test

Measure	Benchmark (Business Today, Oct 2026)	This survey
Price or value is the priority	71%	**39.5%**
Quality is the priority	65%	**32.5%**
Fast delivery is the priority	22%	**6.5%**
Would pay extra for 10-minute delivery	Not reported	**18.0%**

Benchmark respondents could name several priorities, while this survey asks for one top priority. Compare the direction of the result, not the exact percentages.

What the data says

Value wins: price/value (39.5%) and quality (32.5%) both outrank speed (6.5%), the same order as the benchmark.

Meaning for a brand

Build festive campaigns around deals and product quality, and sell speed as a convenience for the 18% who would pay extra.

Four customer segments

1

Speed Seekers

Speed is the top priority and they bought within 48 hours of the festival.

Share 2.0%
Avg spend Rs 7,938

2

Value Hunters

Price or value is the top priority and discount sensitivity is 4 or 5.

Share 32.0%
Avg spend Rs 4,664

3

Brand Loyalists

Brand loyalty is 4 or 5 and their main channel is a brand store.

Share 15.0%
Avg spend Rs 3,945

4

Explorers

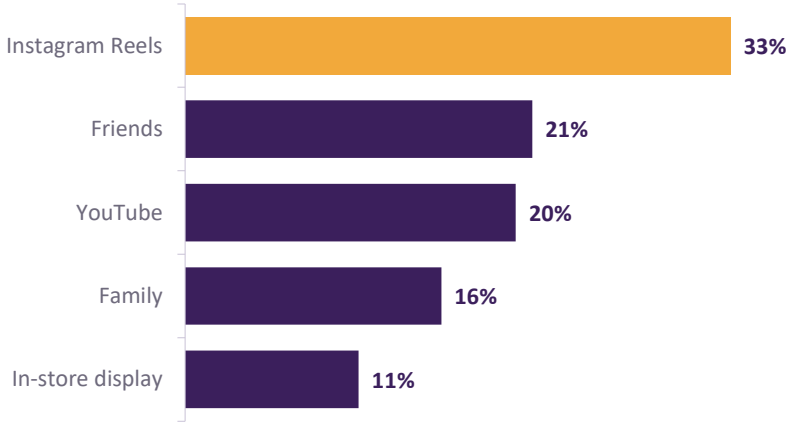
Everyone else, with no single dominant pattern.

Share 51.0%
Avg spend Rs 4,747

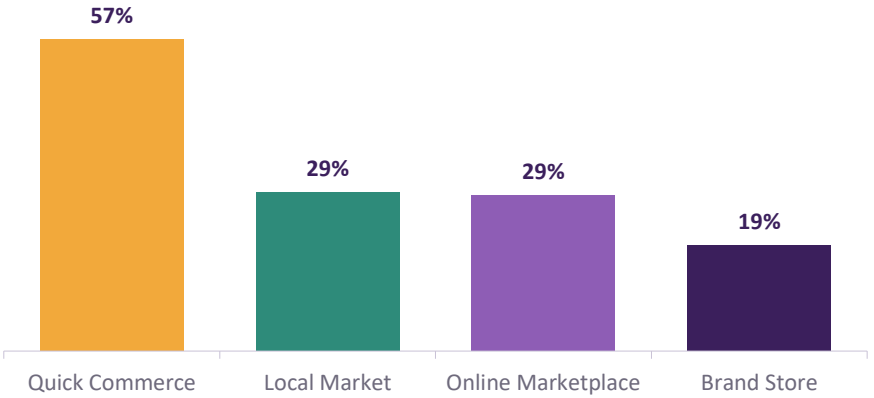
Explorers are the largest group (51%) and Value Hunters the clearest target (32%). Speed Seekers spend the most but are only 4 respondents, so treat them as a niche to test, not a base to build on.

Influence and last-minute buying

What influences purchases



Last-minute buyers by channel



Instagram Reels is the top influence (33%), ahead of friends (21%) and YouTube (20%), so short video should lead festive content.

Quick commerce owns the last-minute window: 57% of its users bought within 48 hours, against 19% for brand stores.

Key findings

1	**Value and quality beat speed for Gen Z festive shoppers in Kolkata.**	72% put value or quality first; only 6.5% put speed first.
2	**Channel use splits three ways, and quick commerce is strongest in the Kolkata core.**	Brand Store 28.5%, Quick Commerce 28.0%, Marketplace 28.0%; quick commerce is 35.9% in the core but 14.9% in other towns.
3	**Quick commerce owns the last-minute window, but few will pay for speed itself.**	57% of quick-commerce users bought within 48 hours; only 18% would pay extra for 10-minute delivery.

Marketing recommendations

Channel

Action

Pre-festive store visit pass with an early styling slot

Target segment

Brand Loyalists (15%)

KPI to track

Footfall, conversion, ABV

Offer and pricing

Action

Festive bundle at a clear set price, such as 3 items for one saving

Target segment

Value Hunters (32%)

KPI to track

Conversion, ABV, UPT

Content and social

Action

Reels with real customers and a 48-hour gift countdown

Target segment

Explorers (51%)

KPI to track

Reel views, click to store, conversion

Limitations and next steps

Limitations

- Convenience sample of 200 respondents, not the whole market
- Spend and priorities are self-reported
- Covers one festive window, Durga Puja to Diwali

Next steps

- Repeat the survey in the wedding season
- Add observed data such as store footfall or app orders
- Pilot one recommendation and measure the result

Conclusion

For Gen Z in Kolkata, value beats speed: 72% put value or quality first and only 6.5% put speed first. Fashion brands should lead festive campaigns with offers and quality, and use quick commerce as the last-minute add-on.

Thank you

Shreyasi Ganguly
shreyasig20@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/contact-shreyasi-ganguly

Sources and definitions

Sources

- Business Today, 27 Oct 2026: Diwali shoppers and quick commerce
- Deccan Herald, Oct 2026: festive sales and quick-commerce order growth
- LocalCircles survey via Upstox, 2026: urban festive spending
- Business Today, 27 Jan 2026: BT-PRICE Gen Z consumption survey
- Primary data: own survey of 200 Gen Z respondents, 2026

Definitions

Quick commerce delivery of everyday and festive items in about 10 to 20 minutes through apps such as Blinkit, Zepto and Instamart

Gen Z respondents aged 18 to 26 in this survey

Festive season Durga Puja to Diwali

Segments rule-based groups defined on the segments slide